

» CRANES, RAILS, AND RELATIVES



23–28 cm
9–11 in

WATER RAIL
Rallus aquaticus
F: Rallidae

Rallus rails are long-billed marsh birds with a narrow body for passing through reed beds. Like other members of the genus, this Eurasian bird is rarely seen away from dense cover.



20–27 cm
8–10½ in

VIRGINIA RAIL
Rallus limicola
F: Rallidae

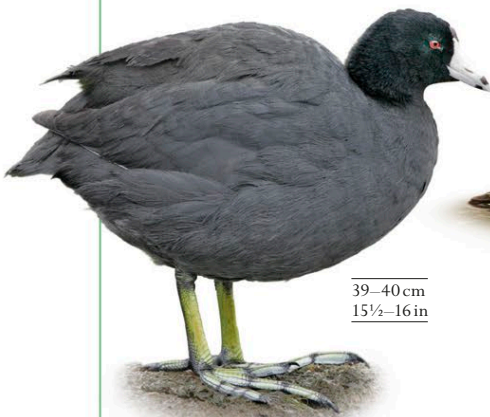
This long-distance migrant has a range from N. America to northern S. America. It is a secretive bird that is difficult to spot.



32–41 cm
12½–16 in

CLAPPER RAIL
Rallus longirostris
F: Rallidae

Unlike many other rails, this tropical American species prefers salt marshes and mangrove swamps. It has a distinctive clacking call.



39–40 cm
15½–16 in

AMERICAN COOT
Fulica americana
F: Rallidae

Found from N. America to northern S. America, this bird, unlike true rails, lives on water. It forages in shallow water and feeds on land.



26–33 cm
10–13 in

SUNGREBE
Heliornis fulica
F: Heliornithidae

This species is a tropical American finfoot. Like all finfoots, it is a secretive bird of slow-moving water, where it feeds on small animals.

red bill with
yellow tip



21–27 cm
8½–10½ in

RUDDY-BREASTED CRAKE
Porzana fusca
F: Rallidae

This crake occurs in wetlands of eastern Asia, but is also seen in mangroves or drier habitats. It has distinctive chestnut-coloured underparts.



purplish blue
underparts

green wings

WHITE-BROWED CRAKE
Porzana cinerea
F: Rallidae

Shorter bills and distinctive calls distinguish crakes from rails. This grey-fronted bird is a typical *Porzana* crake. Its range extends from the Malay Peninsula to Polynesia.

yellow legs



18–22 cm
7–9 in

SORA RAIL
Porzana carolina
F: Rallidae

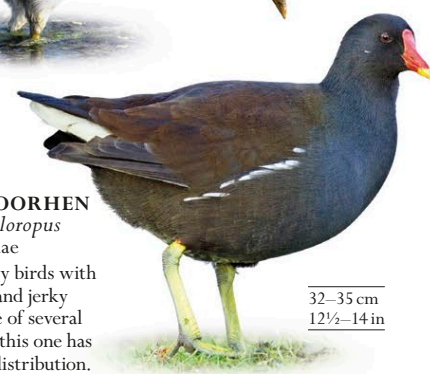
This crake is the commonest N. American member of the rail family. It breeds in shallow wetland and overwinters in the Caribbean.

PURPLE GALLINULE
Porphyrio martinica
F: Rallidae

Occurring in tropical American marshes, this species belongs to a group of rails called swamphens. It is characterized by blue-purple plumage and a blue forehead shield.

COMMON MOORHEN
Gallinula chloropus
F: Rallidae

Moorhens are noisy birds with dark plumage and jerky movements. One of several *Gallinula* species, this one has an almost global distribution.



32–35 cm
12½–14 in